



TRT 102

YOUR BRAIN ON TESTOSTERONE,
THE WAR ON MASCULINITY
& THE LOST CHAPTERS

"I have worked with Dave for a few years now. Not only have we dialled in and drastically improved my health, he has helped me to become a better man in physical, mental and spiritual aspects. Truly grateful to be a client of Dave's, a man who truly cares and is results driven."

— Luke S, SA Australia

DAVE LEE

FOREWORD



Welcome to TRT 102.

If you're reading this, you've most likely read one, or both of my prior releases: TRT 101 and Beyond TRT.

Firstly, thank you for your continued attention, and I hope this book serves to provide you further value in your health journey and understanding.

Secondly, this book is a bit different from the first two.

It is the "lost chapters".

This is everything that didn't quite fit into either one of those books, as well as a collection of pieces I've written in my private community over the years which have resonated powerfully, in one comprehensive, easy to reference guide.

With this trilogy of books, I am confident that I have bestowed upon you, the reader, the knowledge and guidance needed to holistically understand the ins and outs of men's hormone replacement therapy, and the concurrent health and lifestyle interventions necessary to truly become "optimised".

I hope you use this to become the best version of yourself, and to make the world a better place because you are in it.

Let's begin.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

As this is the final book in the trilogy, I'd like to make a special note here.

Throughout the last five years working in this field, I've been blessed to have rubbed shoulders, learnt from and made friends with some of the best and brightest in the industry.

I've appeared on the podcasts I used to listen to, and I've become respected by the people in the space who I look up to.

I've travelled all over the world and met practitioners and clients who have become friends in every country I've visited. I've seen the impact that this knowledge has made on people's lives, that has been far beyond what I could have envisioned when I wrote the first book, or started consulting in this field.

Hundreds of Youtube videos, millions of views and most importantly, thousands of lives saved and changed.

To everyone who's bought a copy of this book, or any of my previous books - *thank you.*

To all my clients over the years and members of the Advanced Fundamental Health community - *thank you.*

To everyone who's supported me and my clients, and trusted me over the years - *thank you.*

A special thank you to:

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Luke, Jordan and Pat at Primal Zone

And of course, my wife Greta, our dog Loki, and my friends James and Colleen for making this book possible, and Aliel Kika for his design and making these books look amazing.

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THE LOST CHAPTERS

SELF DEVELOPMENT DEFINED

MOBILITY

INSOMNIA

SUPPLEMENTS

MOOD, INFLAMMATION & CHRONIC PAIN

CANNABIS

ERECTILE DYSFUNCTION

ALCOHOLISM, OBESITY & CHRONIC STRESS

WRITTEN ARCHIVES



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YOUR BRAIN ON
TESTOSTERONE AND THE
WAR ON MASCULINITY:
INTRODUCTION

My friend Ali Gilbert approached me in 2021 with the idea of putting together an “all things men’s health” summit with the intention to present the best, honest “need to know” subjects for men.

I agreed, and was given the opportunity three times in a row to speak about “whatever I want”.

So I did, and put them all on Youtube because I am a big believer in this knowledge being available for everyone to make an informed decision on how they can, and why they should, get themselves together and optimise their life from all angles.

You can watch the full part 1 ([A / B](#)), [part 2](#) and [part 3](#) lectures online.

I wanted men to know what was going on, what they could do about it and explain it in a way that they could really wrap their heads around.

We need to logically understand things. We need to know how and we need to know why.

We need steps forward, explaining why they’re built that way, why we need to follow them and how to climb them.

So that we can have the motivation, drive, confidence and purpose to execute.

These are those steps.

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YOUR BRAIN ON
TESTOSTERONE AND THE
WAR ON MASCULINITY:
PART I

There are imperative, foundational points that you must intrinsically understand to navigate yourself from where you are now, to where you want to be.

This is not a wafty, esoteric sales pitch. I have nothing to sell.

This is human engineering.

A premise that if you can truly understand the system from which you are operating, you can better optimise its inputs and outputs, and overall function.

You can better understand and execute, life itself.

This chapter covers a foundational view on how testosterone impacts your biological, including neurological, functions and how the modern world is sabotaging this system and has been for some time.

You will learn how to best navigate, efficiently and effectively (biohack) your understanding of the cross section of these systems to begin to understand and not be a casualty in the war on masculinity.

This is the instruction manual you should have had as a teenager.

The hormone testosterone is a powerful, far reaching molecule in men's health, acting as a systemic "marionette" (think, puppet master) for a man's biological, neurological, psychological and physiological functions.

That's a lot of big words.

To put it simply, testosterone is a man's life force.

It impacts every single process in the body, ranging from how your central nervous system fires, your immune system responds, your muscles break down and repair, and how your neurotransmitters are released and synthesised.

It impacts how you sleep, how you think, how you move and how you feel.

It impacts the decisions you make and, ultimately, it serves as the foundation for how you subjectively experience being alive.

Hypogonadism has devastating psychological and physiological consequences. When left untreated, a hypogonadal (low testosterone state) wreaks havoc on the body, brain and mind, predisposing a man to the four primary diseases of ageing: cancer, dementia, diabetes and heart disease, while increasing his risk of developing anxiety, depression and other mood related disorders, such as inattentive ADHD and avoidant personality disorder, from both a neurological and behavioural level.

There are hundreds of thousands of men all over the world who are currently suffering from suboptimal levels of testosterone and have no idea.

Thousands of men each day, all over the world are speaking to their doctors about their hypogonadal symptoms, and despite producing blood tests for sub optimal testosterone levels (if they're lucky enough to have a doctor who will order this test in the first place), are being told their levels are "fine", and being given a diagnosis for their symptoms, not the root cause.

Depression, anxiety, hypersomnia, insomnia, chronic fatigue, insulin resistance, metabolic syndrome, sarcopenia, osteoporosis are all common diagnoses for the symptoms and outcomes of months, years, or even decades of hypogonadism.

These patients are walking out of the doctor's office dissatisfied and hungry for answers, with prescriptions ranging from SSRIs, to pharmaceutical stimulants, tranquilisers and antipsychotics, statins and blood pressure medications and everything in between, that often solve one problem while creating one or two more, known as "side effects".

Thanks to Youtube and other internet platforms, as well as countless individuals who have been raising awareness of hypogonadism in both young and elderly men, more men each day are “waking up” to the true root cause of why they have been going through life surviving, but not thriving.

? *So how and why, does testosterone produce the effects it does?*

? *And how does its deficiency cause such far reaching and devastating consequences?*

Testosterone has a variety of neurosteroidal and behavioural effects. It impacts both how the brain works at a neurochemical level, and also impacts behaviour and psychology in and of itself.

One of the primary, downstream effects of testosterone’s impact on androgen receptors in the brain is its impact on dopamine and GABA, its antioxidant properties and its balancing effects on cortisol and adrenaline.

Let me explain.

Testosterone (and its powerful, primary metabolite DHT) increases dopamine transmission, as well as acting as a positive allosteric modulator of the GABA-A receptor.

This is a powerful one-two punch effect.

By increasing dopamine transmission, the brain releases more dopamine in response to stimuli.

This doesn’t work like drugs of abuse such as cocaine or amphetamine where the brain releases dopamine for free.

It increases the amount of dopamine in response to when dopamine *should* be released.

This means that rewarding behaviour will feel more rewarding. Things that are supposed to feel good, feel good.

As creatures of reward, it is imperative that humans receive the adequate dopamine response to stimuli, to reinforce positive behaviours such as exercise, achieving goals, and feeling motivated and accomplished in day to day life.

The balancing effect on GABA however, is what allows this pathway to truly shine.

GABA is the neurochemical target of sedatives such as benzodiazepines (Valium, Xanax etc) as well as other relaxing agents such as alcohol, relaxing teas or anaesthetics.

It is the “brakes” for excitatory neurotransmission governed by dopamine, noradrenaline and glutamate, as well as hormones such as cortisol and adrenaline.

The balancing effect of stimulating dopamine transmission while also increasing GABAergic activity in the brain is what creates the “cool, calm and collected” effect of optimal androgen levels, rather than acting as a jittery, anxiety inducing stimulant.

This antagonism (balancing effect) on stress hormones such as cortisol and adrenaline, is imperative to the behavioural effects of testosterone, as it allows men to be able to physiologically push outside their comfort zones, without having a nervous breakdown or a panic attack. It is the foundation for discipline and leadership.

It is the very neurochemical cocktail that underpins courage and bravery and the risk being worth the reward when it comes to taking on difficult or challenging tasks.

This pathway is integral for a man's identity development in his adolescent years, both in terms of forging vital skills and cultivating discipline, but ultimately impacting the trajectory of where he ends up and what he has accomplished by the time he reaches his 30s and 40s.

It is also crucial for day-to-day tasks and interactions, as a prophylaxis (preventative) for social anxiety, procrastination, avoidance and the negative outcomes both externally (incompetence) and internally (low self esteem) that come from these maladaptive coping mechanisms.

Sadly, the coping mechanisms get worse.

The medications that young men all over the world are prescribed every day, especially SSRI antidepressants and hair loss medications (5-alpha reductase inhibitors), further blunt the dopaminergic and androgenic pathways while increasing cortisol activity, and in concert with in the developmental years being exposed to unprecedented levels of endocrine disrupting chemicals such as plastic, pollutants and pesticides, we are amidst a true hormonal epidemic, impacting the physical and mental health of men worldwide.

Older men who once experienced optimal androgen levels in their youth are experiencing early onset andropause (think peri-menopause for men) and are robbed of enjoying their golden years due to experiencing the consequences of geriatric testosterone levels in their 40s and 50s, fast-tracking diseased states that should be forestalled for decades, but are instead given pharmaceutical cocktails that allow them to survive and suffer a poor quality of life, robbing them of the fruits of their labour, retirement and enjoying time with the grand-kids.

However, testosterone is NOT a panacea.

The testosterone deficiency diagnosis and treatment protocols are only half the battle.

It's what you do WITH TRT, that makes or breaks the treatment.

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YOUR BRAIN ON
TESTOSTERONE AND THE
WAR ON MASCULINITY:
PART II

Many men walk out of their doctor's office with a prescription for TRT and think their problems are miraculously solved.

A chiselled physique, a leadership-oriented mindset and the resolution to all of their circumstantial problems are just a few injections away.

Wrong.

I wish it was that easy.

Testosterone replacement therapy is a catalyst for change, and provides a man with the opportunity to fix the outcomes of hypogonadism and become the man he could be.

But it doesn't do the work for you. It gives you the foundation to build the house, but you've got to learn how to build it and lay the bricks.

This takes time, and it takes work.

We often say in TRT communities that TRT takes time to work.

And this is true.

But I think it falls short.

Because if you carry on with the same behaviours, mindset and habits as when you were hypogonadal, it might net a small subjective improvement, but it will fall well short of your expectations.

Especially if poor diet and lifestyle habits were what lead you to being hypogonadal in the first place.

"Compliance is the science" is my favourite Stan Efferding quote.

This chapter focuses on the tangibles. What do you actually do, to put this knowledge into action?

Coaching men in this area has taught me a lot.

I see a big disconnect between intention and execution as the variable that determines who achieves their goals and gets results, and who doesn't.

The determining variable isn't setting the alarm for 5am.



It's actually getting up when the alarm goes off.

The determining value isn't the perfectly optimised exercise regime.



It's the consistent, daily application of effort.

I see guys spending hours, obsessively planning on how to perfectly pick up pennies while stepping over multiple \$100 notes in the process.

These are the true biohacks. These are the daily variables that add up over time, to ultimately allow testosterone replacement therapy to work for you the way you expected it would, and ultimately unlock the true potential for how it can work for you.

Here's a few key points to understand:

- Many men are hypogonadal despite doing everything right, due to environmental factors and/or ageing.
- However, many men are also hypogonadal as a consequence of poor diet and lifestyle behaviours, repeated chronically over time. Many men are hypogonadal for good reason.

- The #1 most common source of side effects on TRT is the unresolved root cause of hypogonadism, or the uncorrected maladaptive behaviours and coping mechanisms that developed as a response to the subjective effects of hypogonadism.

To put it simply. You feel like shit because you treat your body like shit. And you treat your body like shit because you feel like shit.

This is called a “positive feedback loop”.

I think that sounds like a good thing.

So, I prefer to call it a “vicious cycle”.

I have met thousands of men over the recent years caught in this vicious cycle.

And it is a difficult cycle to break, especially when there is a disconnection between expectations and reality.

Many men do not understand that in order to feel and look their best, and achieve their expectations of what testosterone replacement therapy can do for them, they need to adopt the diet and lifestyle habits of a man who would be making those levels of testosterone if he could.

ie, you need to earn your TRT, or it won't work.

And worse, it will produce side effects.

My most simple and overarching advice on this area of your health journey is:



Stop doing all the things you know you shouldn't be doing.

and



Start doing all the things you know you should be doing.

There's a good chance it's that simple.

And there's also a good chance that if you were the person who consistently made those changes 6-12 months ago, you'd be the person that you want to be now. The person that you could be.

However, sometimes it's not that straightforward. Sometimes we don't know the key areas that are sabotaging our results.

I often meet men who are applying high levels of discipline and dedication into certain areas while completely neglecting or overlooking others, and having little to show for their efforts.

This is discouraging and disheartening, and can often lead men back to the very vices they've been fighting away.

Ultimately, you have to do it all. It has to be about balance.

You have to tick every box.

Especially that box that you don't want to tick.

There's a great saying: You can't out-train a bad diet. And while from a body composition standpoint, you might be able to construct your macros around a junk- food oriented diet and achieve the body fat levels you desire...

Food and nutrition are about more than calories, and health is about more than body fat percentage (even though it does play a major role).

There are three primary areas of excess that hold men back and one key deficiency.

Drugs, alcohol, junk food, and not enough exercise.

This may sound simple, but in my experience as a TRT health coach for the last five years working day in and day out with thousands of men, **it is as simple as understanding how few vices you can get away with and how much movement is required to feel the way you want to feel.**

Eliminating alcohol completely, or keeping alcohol to 1-2 standard drinks per week and never binge drinking, is the quickest and easiest health intervention that has the most far reaching effect on physical and mental health.

And excess alcohol consumption is one of the key root causes for side effects on TRT.



Note: Zero alcohol is significantly better than 1-2 drinks per week. 1-2 drinks is the absolute most someone can “get away with”, but it is not a free lunch. If you’re serious about your health, don’t drink at all.

The second most common cause of side effects is excess body fat, and the concurrent insulin resistance that occurs as both a cause and effect.

Many men have a perception that abs are just for the beach in summer, and that having a bit of a “dad bod” is fine, as long as their wife doesn’t complain about it.

If you aren’t proud of how you look naked, and you’re experiencing side effects on TRT, there’s a good chance you’ve found your root cause.

Men *must* be below 15% body fat to avoid varying degrees of insulin resistance.

The less insulin sensitive a man is, the more side effects he will experience on TRT.

My friend and best-selling author, Jay Campbell has been championing the importance of being lean and maintaining optimal insulin sensitivity for health for over a decade, and he went on record many years ago stating the “estrogenic” side effects on TRT are due to insulin resistance.

And he could not be more correct.

To experience optimal health in life, and especially on TRT, men must have a healthy relationship with exercise and nutrition to be able to nourish the body with micronutrient dense, non-inflammatory foods and maintain a lean, healthy body fat percentage. It's not just about looking great, it's about feeling great.



PLUG: Jay has some great books on losing body fat incorporating living what he refers to as an “insulin controlled lifestyle” and utilising therapeutic adjuncts. You can check out *The Metabolic Blowtorch* diet as well as *30 Days to Shreds*.

My friend Ali Gilbert, who is a fitness coach and TRT expert and enthusiast, has also developed a much needed program called GPP for TRT, a program designed to help men get themselves into shape when starting TRT, incorporating positive diet and exercises changes to reach a healthy body fat percentage to support optimal mental, physical and sexual function.

Finally, my friends Luke Leaman and Max Hogan are the masterminds at [Muscle Nerds](#), who can help provide high-level customised exercise programs for those who are facing challenges with injuries or desire a highly customised regime to achieve their goals.

Here are my top, actionable tips to get started:

1 PRACTISE MINDFULNESS MEDITATION EVERY DAY

Mindfulness meditation is the cheapest, easiest intervention for mental health and has the lowest compliance rate out of any intervention on this list.

Men (and women) will make any excuse not to meditate. This is because it is boring, uncomfortable, and it can feel difficult and pointless at the start.

However, the more difficult you find meditation, the chances are, the more you need it. Just like cardio and mobility work.

Finding 10-15 minutes per day to practise mindfulness (focusing your attention on the present moment) is a pragmatic and effective way to learn to regulate your emotions, audit your behaviour, build the mental skills of focus and attention, and learn to regulate and manage your stress response.

I have a video explanation of mindfulness [here](#) as well as a full Youtube [lecture](#).

I highly recommend the Headspace app, [this](#) 15 minute meditation from Alan Watts on Youtube, or listening through the Power of Now by Eckhart Tolle.

2 PERFORM STRETCHING AND MOBILITY WORK EVERY DAY

This is especially important if you work a sedentary job.

Years of restricted movement patterns and psychological anxiety can wreak havoc on your connective tissue and posterior chain, especially if you're about to get in the gym and start throwing around heavy weights.

A mobility routine doesn't have to be arduous or painful, but it has to be done with frequency.

I recommend following along with a Youtuber like Tom Merrick, Instagrammer "Elastaboy" or a program from Jujimufu, or do what I did and go down to your local yoga studio and do a 10-30 day challenge, then practise what you learnt at home.

3 DO CARDIO REGULARLY

Walking doesn't count. Sorry

You must perform cardiovascular fitness to train and improve your cardiovascular system. Especially while on TRT.

Poor cardiovascular fitness is the most common cause of high blood pressure on TRT.

Find a form of cardio you enjoy, and to take this to the next level, perform cardio at different levels of intensity, such as low intensity steady state as well as high intensity bursts such as sprinting.

I personally prefer the elliptical as I can "zone out" and listen to my favourite music, or sprinting barefoot on the beach or grass. I also like the Concept 2 rowing machine and the Rogue Echo bike for HIIT sprints.

For anyone who struggles with compliance for their cardio and is time poor/has a young family, I strongly suggest getting a cardio machine at home. A recumbent bike in front of the TV with Netflix or an Xbox/Playstation is a great way to increase compliance, and you can often pick up an affordable machine on Facebook market.

Do whatever form of cardio you will do and do it more.

4 WALK 10,000+ STEPS PER DAY

This one is a cliché for a reason.

Since 2020, a lot of men have significantly reduced their non-exercise energy expenditure due to working from home, and having access to more conveniences with the internet and other forms of technology.

It is common for men to tell me they aim to get 10,000 steps per day, but as they consistently fall short most days and rarely exceed this, they end up averaging closer to 5,000 steps.

This is an easy and free intervention that expedites fat loss, supports the posterior chain and does wonders for mental health. Take your wife, girlfriend, kids or dog with you if that's a barrier.

I like to listen to audiobooks and podcasts on walks as it gives me time to think and contemplate what I'm learning. This is a great "two birds, one stone" scenario.

No time? Get up earlier. Starting your day with a 60 minute walk will do wonders for your metabolism and mood throughout the day, and will also start you off with a habit and behaviour that is a small win to set up positive momentum for healthy habits and choices for the day ahead.

5 REDUCE/ELIMINATE JUNK FOOD

Especially deep fried food, as well as hyper processed, micronutrient devoid foods high in refined sugar with a long shelf life.

These foods are high in oxidised omega 6 polyunsaturated fats that are devoid of micronutrient content and produce inflammatory byproducts in the body. They disrupt the balance of Omega 3:6, a contributor to many mood and health disorders.

Foods high in preservatives, refined sugar, stabilisers, gums, artificial colours and sweeteners are well known to contribute to insulin resistance and gut dysbiosis, as well as over-eating, and these synthetic additives have unknown long-term consequences and may contribute to cancer, while being high in calories and devoid of micronutrition.

Eliminate these junk and deep fried foods entirely, if not as much as possible, and notice how much better your mood and energy levels are day to day. Pay particular attention to how you feel before and after each meal. If you feel worse after eating it, your body is sending you an important signal.

There are lots of different nutrition gurus to fit different palettes or fitness goals. I recommend checking out Mike Dolce, Paul Saladino, Stan Efferding, Pete Evans and Mark Sisson. “Joeysorts” on Instagram is a great influencer to follow for inspiration.

6 INCREASE INTAKE OF NUTRIENT DENSE, ANTIOXIDANT RICH FOODS

Depending on which rabbit hole of the internet you go down, you will be told that x is good and y is bad.

There are compelling arguments to be made for many approaches to nutrition.

What I have found in practice with my clients, is that increasing the intake of meat (especially red meat), high quality dairy (if tolerated) and pasture raised eggs leads to improved blood work and subjective health outcomes across the board.

I find that many of the nutrients people take as supplements for health and performance, and are often deficient in when running micronutrient blood work analysis, are the nutrients found in red meat. Especially methylated B vitamins, iron and zinc, as well as performance boosting nutrients such as carnitine, choline and creatine.

High quality egg yolks are especially dense in fat soluble nutrients often lacking in the diet, and they also promote satiety to prevent over-eating.

I believe a healthy, balanced diet should be focused on red meat, followed by white meat, a plethora of eggs (not discarding the yolk), fatty fish, organic pasture raised full-fat dairy, and organic fruits and vegetables.

While minimally processed grains can be incorporated if well digested, starchy vegetables such as potatoes and sweet potatoes contain more micronutrients per gram/calorie, and should be prioritised.

Where possible, shop for grass fed meats and organic fruits and vegetables from local farmers and farmers' markets to eat the healthiest animal products, achieve minimal exposure to harmful pesticides and support local businesses.

7 CUT THE DRUGS AND ALCOHOL

Recreational drugs have no place in a mentally and physically healthy man's life.

Recreational drugs, consumed deliberately to produce a sense of intoxication, such as amphetamine, cocaine, as well as abusive doses of opioids and benzodiazapines are neurotoxic, and will produce long term damage to the brain.

An often overlooked aspect of drug and alcohol abuse is the time and opportunity wasted for self development, and the importance of creating a life that does not require escapism.

It is imperative to use nights and weekends to practise self development behaviours to enrich the quality of your own life and those around you, rather than escaping reality and suffering from the toxic aftermath, limiting your physical and mental performance for the coming days.

While in your teenage years with fewer responsibilities and foresight/life experience these activities may have been appealing and socially acceptable, they have no place in a mature man's life, as this time must be dedicated to mastering self and developing skills that will underpin the foundation for the years of life to come.

If you are reading this and are in your 30s and 40s and still celebrate every weekend with abusing drugs and alcohol, it is time to take a long hard look in the mirror and ask yourself if you are truly proud of the man you are and the choices you have made, and consider the man you could be and the life you could be living now, had this time and energy been used productively.

8 PRACTISE MARTIAL ARTS

One of the most powerful forms of experiential therapies is martial arts.

Martial arts training, in any discipline, allows men to “get comfortable being uncomfortable”.

This is how you can practically push your comfort zone further each week, and learn and practise a real life skill requiring you to “keep your cool” in a physically stressful and challenging situation.

Learning martial arts and practising meditation is what I have referred to for many years as the “yin and yang” approach to mental health, and I have seen it do wonders in men who are easily overwhelmed, anxious, and feel ashamed and guilty for not being more like the men they admire.

Sound familiar?

The most powerful martial arts lesson is your second session.

The first one you didn't know what you were in for.

The second one is when you chose to come back.

The worse you are at martial arts, the more there is to learn.

I recommend practising the martial art that appeals the most to you. They all have merit and application in the real world.

When in doubt, practise the martial art that has the best coach near you and learn from them.

Practising grappling and/or striking is a cathartic and therapeutic process of letting go of stress, learning how to take care of yourself, and building physical competence.

The benefits of this practice are far reaching. Learning to manage your stress response in a highly stressful environment makes it far easier to manage it in less stressful day to day situations.

If you find yourself overwhelmed by life's day to day challenges such as opening your inbox, getting on an uncomfortable phone call, going on a date or keeping up with your chores, consider doing something acutely far harder and more stressful, and watch how everything else feels easier by comparison.

9 RECONSIDER AND REASSESS THE USE OF PSYCHIATRIC MEDICATIONS

 **Note:** *This is NOT medical advice. Psychiatric drugs have their time and place. If you are currently being treated with psychiatric medications you must discuss any intention to reduce/withdraw your medication with your doctor/psychiatrist. This content is not directed towards those with serious mental health conditions, but speaks to men who have been taking SSRIs or other psychiatric medications for low-grade mood disorders, and who have not achieved resolution of their negative symptoms.*

SSRI antidepressants, as well as other psychiatric drugs, are often prescribed unknowingly for symptoms caused by hormonal dysfunction.

A major problem with SSRIs is their side effects.

Significantly elevating serotonin activity in the synapse by preventing its re-uptake, can impact the careful balance of neurotransmitters in the brain, notoriously leading to anhedonia (reduction in pleasure), somnolence and erectile dysfunction.

When the negative mood symptoms leading to a man seeking treatment are caused by low testosterone, it can often make the situation worse, not better.

While TRT may lead to a hypogonadal man feeling better than he felt before, the concurrent use of SSR's, in my experience, will often lead to an incomplete response to TRT, especially regarding sexual function and libido.

If the underlying root cause of your mood disorder has resolved with TRT, but you do not feel as though you have fully responded to treatment, it may be time to reassess the role of an SSRI in your biology.

However, withdrawing from SSRIs is not a straightforward task, and the longer a man has been on them the harder it is to withdraw from them. It is imperative that this is discussed with, and overseen by, your doctor.

10 GIVE YOURSELF A REASON TO BE PROUD

Easier said than done.

Pride is the cornerstone of a man's mental health.

One of the best cures for insomnia is laying down at the end of the day, proud of what you have accomplished.

Your inner monologue is your harshest critic, and doesn't give out participation medals.

When you step into embracing the challenges of life, overcoming obstacles and living true to your purpose, it is easier to be at peace with the voice inside your head, as there is no guilt or second guessing whether you are living up to your full potential.

Be proud to be taking a step forward to overcoming your challenges and being a better man today than you were yesterday.

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YOUR BRAIN ON
TESTOSTERONE AND THE
WAR ON MASCULINITY:
PART III

The concluding chapter in this series, is expanding on the “why?”

I believe many of us are focused, consciously or unconsciously, on improving the subjective experience of being alive.

I believe that this can be achieved through a thorough understanding of our psychological and biological systems, exactly what to execute, and how to get to the final destination of being the man we want to be.

Or, how and why we fall off and keep falling off, the path in the journey to that destination.

I wrote this chapter thinking: “if I could get all my clients in one room and say one thing to all of you, it’s this”.

We all want to feel better, and to be our best.

This can be to alleviate suffering, or to get the most out of life, both physically and mentally.

Many men start due to the former, and continue due to the latter.

One of the biggest failures of modern medicine, as well as psychology, psychiatry AND the “biohacking” space, is the view of the body and mind as disconnected systems.

This could not be further from how the human body works.

In November 2023 I gave a lecture at the Silverback Summit where I compared the human experience to the animated Pixar movie, “Cars”.

An interconnected series of systems forming a machine, that is sentiently experiencing itself being alive.

I believe this is a fantastic metaphor for understanding the relationship between the vessel and consciousness.

This is the mind body connection.

While interconnected, the consciousness is still capable of independent thought and action, but it is heavily influenced by, and experiences, feedback with biological systems.

There are some key take-aways from this philosophy to drill down upon.

1 YOU CANNOT HAVE A HEALTHY MIND AND AN UNHEALTHY BODY

You may be able to (try to) use psychiatric drugs to trick your brain into thinking you're doing better than you are, but these almost always result in lacklustre outcomes, as well as side effects.

The body is far more complex than hijacking just one system to solve for the outcomes of diet, lifestyle, traumas, decisions and behaviours.

It is like replacing one part of the engine and expecting to bulletproof the entire driving experience, or finish at a different destination.

i Inflammatory processes in the muscles, joints, digestive and detoxification systems impact neurotransmitters.

Ever heard of the gut/ brain connection?

Had to urinate due to nervousness?

Felt sick due anxiety?

Or felt anxiety because you had an upset stomach?

The systems work both ways, in a symbiotic relationship.

This means it is integral to focus on both optimising and fixing any issues relating to **both** the biology and the psychology.

You cannot out-biology your psychology.

You cannot out-psychology your biology.

- ii Chronic inflammation downregulates dopamine production, receptor availability and synthesis, and increases dopamine reuptake.

What does this mean?

It means that when your body is in pain or unhealthy, things that are supposed to feel good, just don't feel as good as they should.

This is a big problem for not only the subjective experience of the present moment, but dictating your future behaviours.

A body in pain and under stress will have higher levels of circulating cortisol and adrenaline at baseline.

This can be subjectively experienced as "generalised anxiety".

 **Note:** Chronic inflammation is not the only cause of anxiety and depression, but it is impossible to completely resolve these negative subjective experiences with a body that is a burning dumpster fire.

2 SERVICE YOUR BODY MORE OFTEN THAN YOU SERVICE YOUR CAR

We know the importance of not driving a car that needs a service. It makes the problem worse and it results in a bigger bill from the mechanic.

The same can be said for our health.

We know that getting your car serviced regularly is the best way to avoid major mechanical issues, as you can identify and fix small problems before they become big problems.

"Health Coaching" is a relatively new field of healthcare, where people are able to preventatively and proactively manage their health, before they acquire a severe disease diagnosis.

I believe this is the future of health care, and more and more clinics and practitioners are seeing the value in keeping people healthy, rather than waiting for people to get sick before making an intervention.

There's no need to wait until the wheels fly off before fixing the car.

Comprehensive blood work, as well as an in-depth assessment of your health, fitness, diet, lifestyle and symptoms, performed every 6-12 months is the best way to "see around the corner", and get crucial objective feedback on how you're living.



Note: *Most doctors have not been trained in preventative care and health optimisation, and many health coaches will be biased in their practice to sell you whatever supplements or treatments they make a commission on.*

Just like mechanics, there are good health coaches and there are bad health coaches.

Ensure you work with a health coach who shows receipts for their work, has an active and supportive community of healthy, thriving clients and who walks the walk themselves.

3 THE 3 KEYS

What does all of this cumulate to?

I believe there are 3 key attributes men must embody, facilitated by optimal androgen levels and positive diet and lifestyle practices that allow him to achieve and maintain his expectations from TRT.

- i Purpose: Purpose must be present to facilitate, drive and motivate a man on his self development journey.**

Purpose is the “why”.

Purpose is what over-rides the impulse to return to vices, hit the snooze button, show up day in day out, prolong instant reward gratification, lean into discomfort, and, to put it simply: do the hard thing.

Many men say they want to feel better. But *why*?

It's the *why* that will be the determining factor as to whether he keeps his word to himself, upholds discipline in the face of temptation, and facilitate key point #2.

- ii Pride: Pride, a sense of accomplishment and achievement, must be earned.**

Pride is an antidote to depression and low self esteem, and is the mute switch to the negative self talk that keeps many men awake at night when their head hits the pillow.

It is difficult to be self tortuous when you genuinely know you are living up to your potential and living a purposeful, meaningful existence.

Here's the tricky part: Pride cannot be faked. You are your own greatest critic and you see exactly how you show up when no one else is watching.

- iii Courage & Bravery: These are the hallmark of fictional male heroes from ancient mythology up until modern Hollywood cinema for *a reason*.**

Fearlessness is dangerous and goes against survival mechanisms. Fears can be both irrational and rational, and it is perfectly rational to be afraid of many things.

However, the differentiator is the ability and capacity to overcome fear, to conquer it and to push through. This requires courage and bravery.

Courage and bravery are skills and attributes that can be cultivated and honed by regularly pushing outside your comfort zone.

Doing challenging things regularly and programming micro doses of adversity into your life are keys to preventing complacency and learned fear from setting in.

Life is hard. You need to be harder.

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THE LOST CHAPTERS: SELF DEVELOPMENT DEFINED

What is self development?

Self development is the ultimate biohack.

Becoming habituated to a practice of self development you intrinsically enjoy is the key.

That is

Love doing the thing that's good for you.

This is the fast track for upgrading your life.

Learn to fall in love with good things: exercise, eating healthy food, practising good sleep hygiene and improving knowledge, more than you love doing the bad things: destructive vices, hedonistic behaviours and consumption of toxic drugs, alcohol and junk food.

When you can find a way to make the former genuinely more enjoyable than the latter, you can invest more time and energy in building, or rebuilding yourself, rather than destroying it on Friday nights and weekends, or Monday to Friday in the lunch-room.

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THE LOST CHAPTERS: **MOBILITY**

I do not pretend to be an exercise or movement expert.

To speak to the experts, contact my friends [Ali Gilbert](#), [Muscle Nerds](#), [Charlie Weingroff](#), or [Stephen Hooper](#).

I can, however, speak as someone who neglected mobility work for decades and suffered the consequences, and has seen the same patterns play out over and over again with my clients.

You must perform regular mobility work.

Especially if you are working a sedentary job and lifting weights.

This lack of low grade movement, shortening and tensing the body through resistance training and not compensating for this by adequately stretching wreaks havoc in the long run.

Especially when compounded with psychological stress and anxiety.



Tip: Build a quick, easy mobility routine that you don't dread doing. Do it every day at a minimum. Twice a day is best. Make it efficient and effective.

Commission a physiotherapist or personal trainer to put together a targeted routine for you.

Or, attend a 10 day yoga studio trial, learn the basics and put something together yourself.

Do what you will do, and do it often.

Especially focus on stretching and opening through the full spine and hips.

This routine should last for a minimum of 5-10 minutes, and takes your whole body through a full range of motion.

Common movements can include:

- Glute bridge
- Plank
- Side plank
- Resistance band pull
- Ass-To-Grass Split Squat
- Couch stretch
- Lunges
- Deep squats
- Downward dog
- Cobra
- Single leg deadlift
- Side bends
- Forward fold
- Pigeon Pose

If you work a sedentary job, especially if you work from home, it will serve you in the short term, and especially the long term, by getting up and stretching for 5-10 minutes throughout the day, as many times as you can. Try doing it on the hour, or every time you go to the bathroom for a few days in a row and notice the difference in how you feel.

You don't need supplements or anything in a bottle to relax, you need to **focus on what you can do**, not what you can take, when a physical problem arises in the body.

However, if you are looking to take a supplement stack at the end of the day to unwind and relax the body after training or to prepare rest, I have found the following stack to be very effective:

Unwind:

- 500-1000mg Meriva Curcumin
- 1000-2000mg Krill Oil
- 400mg Magnesium Glycinate
- 300mg Phosphatidylserine
- 200-400mg L Theanine
- 500mg -1000mg Reduced Glutathione

Optional Additions:

- 10-200mg CBD
- 250-500mg Lemon Balm
- 300-600mg Relora

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**THE LOST CHAPTERS:
INSOMNIA**

The most important thing that everyone can do to improve sleep is to have a proper sleep hygiene ritual, first and foremost.

Again: Always consider what can you “do” before what can you “take”.

This is the foundation to what you take. The foundation is what makes the supplements work properly.

Aside from brushing your teeth, your sleep hygiene should include **stretching your whole body** (especially if you are primarily sedentary), a **hot shower** (some people benefit from cold showers at night too), and a conscious effort to **remove exposure to blue light** for, at minimum 30 minutes, ideally 1-2 hours prior to bed.

Yes, this means, no scrolling in bed. Get a book.

You can get blue blocking glasses if you wish. I prefer to install a program like “f.lux” on my computer and settings on my phone to take the blue out of the screens, and use a pair of red tinted glasses if I am using a computer in the evening.

You can upgrade your pre-sleep routine with mindfulness meditation, with as little as a few minutes of conscious breathing when you lay down.

Meditation tip: Install the headspace app, or another guided meditation app to learn the basics on how to practise mindfulness meditation. *Find a narrator that doesn’t piss you off - that’s the key.*

I have a full lecture on Mindfulness Meditation on the TRT and hormone optimisation channel called “[Mindfulness on TRT](#)” for a more in depth explanation.

In essence, you must learn the skill of disconnecting from your racing thoughts and what’s on your mind, as well as being able to create a silence internally to be able to fall asleep.

Even when those thoughts are creating stress, fear and anxiety.

Especially when those thoughts are creating stress, fear and anxiety.

It may be very reasonable to be concerned or worried about what is ahead in your life, but you must be able to switch off from these thought processes at night to be able to rest and recover to effectively take on these challenges the next day.

In “Supplements”, I have included a full guide to sleep supplement protocols. These should be layered on top of these practices as a foundation.

Especially the mindfulness component.

Too many men rely on prescription medications or cocktails of supplements to switch their minds off for them, and this skill is critical for your mental health, as well as rest and recovery processes.

Taking a chemical brick to the head every night before you go to bed will cause grogginess, lethargy and short term memory issues in the short term, and psychological and neurological issues in the long term.

Sleep Formula:

- 300-600mg Phosphatidylserine
- 200-600mg L Theanine
- 400mg Magnesium Glycinate
- Optional:
- 10-200mg CBD
- 300-600mg KSM 66 Ashwagandha
- 1-20mg Micronised Melatonin
- 10-30g Collagen/Gelatine

There are no magical sleep stacks (despite what you may have seen in a Youtube clickbait title).

There are sleep supplements and combinations that work better for some than others, based on their individual genetics, as well as what is leading them to having sleep difficulties in the first place.

I have spent hundreds of hours researching sleep supplements mechanistically, as well as working with thousands of clients all over the world on supporting their sleep and recovery, which is one of the primary areas of concern men have when consulting with me.

I prefer to stick to treatments that are:

- Undoubtedly safe
- Health promoting beyond just improving sleep and subjective relaxation
- Produce the lowest instances of side effects across a broad population

This has lead me to a combination of phosphatidylserine, theanine and magnesium, used in clinically effective doses.

These nutrients synergistically modulate the rest and relaxation neurotransmitters and nervous system, while providing the raw materials the body needs to make calming neurotransmitters, facilitate rest and relaxation processes, and to buffer the adrenal's response to stress.

When someone needs a nudge in the “calmer” direction, I primarily recommend CBD, as it is an extremely effective and safe antioxidant, and is anti-inflammatory, with benefits reaching far beyond a good night's sleep.

However, as CBD is not for everyone, I also recommend Ashwagandha, that is very effective for those with high levels of cortisol and prolactin in their bloodwork. However, this is a very strong supplement and can be too strong for those who are not chronically stressed.

Melatonin can be started in a 1-3mg dose and titrated up by 1-2mg per

night every few nights. If the dose goes too high, sleep will be disturbed. 3-10mg is the sweet spot for most of my clients. Those with autoimmune conditions and serious chronic injuries benefit from 10-20mg doses.

Collagen/Gelatine is a great source of calming amino acids including glycine and proline. 5g of glycine is an extremely effective and safe addition to provide a further calming effect, and if budget is an issue, it can be purchased as a straight powder that has a pleasant sweet taste.

! **CAUTION:** *One of the most important things when considering what to take, is considering what to take out. This is the “you can’t out-train a bad diet”, with supplements.*

They help, but they don’t fix.

What is the #1 cause of avoidable chronic stress issues in my clients?

Stimulants.

Pharmaceutical stimulants, stimulating nootropics, stimulating herbs, stimulating blue light. Caffeine. Pre- workouts.

If you overstimulate yourself, your sympathetic and parasympathetic nervous system will fall out of balance. You will chemically lock yourself into a jacked up, cranked and “wired” state.

Combine that with a dysregulated circadian rhythm and, for many, understimulated bodies from not doing enough movement over the day, it’s no wonder you can’t sleep.

Pull the excessive stimulants out and modulate the caffeine, before loading up on natural sedatives and relaxing agents.

Keep caffeine <300mg, or <150mg if you’re sensitive. Consider cutting it out completely if it doesn’t agree with you. Definitely cut it out after noon.

✔ **Note:** 300mg is the ceiling where fast caffeine metabolisers won't receive side effects. 150mg is the ceiling where slow/moderate caffeine metabolisers (the majority of the population) won't receive side effects.

Can't sleep? High blood pressure? Anxiety? If you're having any more than 2-3 shots of espresso per day, consider cutting this down first.

✔ **Note:** I love combining Theanine with Caffeine during the day as a nootropic.

Green tea naturally has a 2:1 ratio of Theanine to Caffeine which and is the ratio I personally prefer, however, many prefer 1:1 or in a 1:2 ratio of theanine to caffeine. See what works for you. This is one of the most basic, yet often overlooked nootropics that is very safe, side effect free and very beneficial for the body and mind. I prefer the "suntheanine" varieties with no filler, from brands such as Paradise Herbs or Sports Research. I take 200-400mg with a strong cup of coffee.

If you're using pre-workouts and drinking coffee and energy drinks, or especially if you're layering things like pharmaceutical stimulants or stimulating nootropics, it might be time to realise you're not getting away with it, and pull back significantly on stimulant use.. You'll feel better for it in the long run.

What goes up, must come down.



THE LOST CHAPTERS: SUPPLEMENTS

SUPERFOODS

Real superfoods should be the cornerstone of your diet and supplement budget.

What are superfoods?

“Superfoods” is a bastardised and cringey term in the supplement industry but, by definition, it can be considered food that is “super” good for your body.

It's just what constitutes that term which carries contention...

Superfoods actually are:

- Red meat, especially grass fed, regenerative, ecological produce
- Organ meats from grass-fed, healthy animals
- Whole eggs, especially pasture raised
- Wild caught, contaminant free, omega 3 rich fish
- High quality, grass fed, ecological dairy
- Organic fruits and cold pressed, fresh juices
- Organic greens and micro algae such as spirulina, chlorella, wheatgrass and more



Note: *This is not a book on nutrition. Nutrition is a contentious subject in the fitness and healthcare industry.*

My approach to nutrition is: focus on foods that are rich in micronutrients and minimally processed, especially from whole ingredients that you cook yourself. I focus on the intake of omega 3s due to their well documented benefits, vitamins A, E, D and K from high quality animal fat such as ghee and grass fed red meat, along with methylated B vitamins, red meat, creatine, carnitine and amino acids from meat. I also support the intake of antioxidant and polyphenol rich plant foods that are free from/minimally exposed to pesticides with a strong concentration of nutrients.

For nutrition resources, check out Christopher Walker's Thermo Diet, Mark Sisson's Primal Blueprint, The Dolce Diet and, for bodybuilders, Stan Efferding's Vertical Diet.

I think the vertical diet is also a better option than the “autoimmune paleo” protocol for IBS/digestive issues and for those with fast metabolisms needing to put on/maintain body weight.

Daily Foundational Protocol:

- 1-2 Servings Organic Greens Powder
- 1-2 Servings Desiccated Organ Capsules
- 2000-4000mg EPA+DHA from high quality, non-contaminated triglyceride fish oil

Optional:

- 15-30ml Tart Cherry
- 500mg-2g Royal Jelly
- 500mg-1g Shilajit
- 2-5g Colostrum
- 30-60g Cold filtered whey protein from grass fed cows

These are the supplements that few people really “need” and everyone can benefit from.

 **Note:** *I strongly recommend this supplement foundation for people with surgeries such as lap band or gastric sleeves, gallbladder removal or autoimmune digestive issues such as celiac, chrohn's disease and ulcerative colitis. If digestion/nutrient absorption is compromised, nutritional supplementation is very worthwhile. If nutrient assimilation is an issue, consider Thorne's broad spectrum, bioavailable multivitamin products.*

Most supplements are specified for their application, such as sleep, energy, stress or pain.

These supplements are a nutritional foundation recommended for all my clients who want to take supplements.

For a **multivitamin**, I recommend Thorne's Basic or Advanced Nutrients products. These include all the important methylated B vitamins, minerals in high quality bioavailable forms, mixed sources of Vitamin E, Vitamin A as Retinol and a healthy dose of Vitamin K, often omitted from multi vitamins due to price. Poor quality multivitamins are inflammatory and not bioavailable. Thorne has been my multivitamin recommendation for years. Get it from iHerb, Amazon or wherever they sell good supplements.

For **greens**, I prefer a blend of as many medicinal herbs, fruits, plants and mushrooms as possible to promote alpha diversity in the gut. These powders must be organic, and for my preference, minimally processed and unflavoured. I have been using the Paradise Herbs ORAC Energy Greens for years. It comes in a convenient capsule form for those who won't drink the powder. I simply mix it with ½-1 cup of orange juice and it goes down just fine. Don't be a baby. Organifi make a delicious tasting greens powder, for those looking for a more palatable option.

Desiccated Organs including liver, heart, kidney, pancreas and spleen provide a broad spectrum of bioavailable vitamins, minerals and other nutrients essential for optimal human function. 1-2 servings have about the same micronutrient density as around 200g of high quality red meat. These are a great, cost effective way to get organ meat into the diet, but if you've got the palate and culinary skills for it, including fresh high quality organ meat as part of the diet is always going to be your best bet.

Omega 3 is an essential nutrient for optimal human physiological function. Due to an increased, often chronic intake of Omega 6 via vegetable oil and processed food, gaining large quantities of high quality Omega 3 in the diet, or via supplementation has been a game-changer for many of my clients. There are currently close to 40,000 studies on pubmed on Omega 3, and most studies look at a dose of 2-4g of combined EPA and DHA per day well beyond what many softgels contain, of only 100-200mg. This means that you'd need to often take 10-20 softgels per day of fish oil

from the pharmacy to reach this dose, but in the process, you'd also be intaking a large amount of potentially rancid, high calorie fat.

I strongly recommend not shopping for fish oil on a budget. The best quality and most economical, highly concentrated fish oil I have found is from Sports Research, as its Triple Strength Omega product. Thorne also makes a great, high strength product too. I recommend 2g daily for all my clients, and up to 4g daily for those with chronic inflammatory conditions, or who grew up on a junk-food diet.

 **Note:** This is combined EPA and DHA, not grams of total fish oil. Look on the label, add EPA and DHA together, and multiply the amount of softgels required to reach this dose daily. I prefer to split the total daily dose AM and PM, and personally take 2 softgels of Sports Research Triple Strength Omega 2x daily.

 **Note:** You can't out-supplement a bad diet. I wouldn't recommend spending hundreds of dollars on superfood powders and capsules per month if the quality of your diet is not already excellent. Your dollar goes a lot further at the farmers' market or grocery store than it does at the supplement store.



ADAPTOGENS

Adaptogenic herbs are misconstrued in the meaning of "adaptogenic".

I have seen numerous articles, sales pitches and product descriptions directly stating that these herbs have pseudo-magical properties, where they change their mechanism of action based on what your body needs.

Laughable.

Not only is this completely impossible, but this is not what the term "adaptogen" means.

Adaptogenic herbs, such as Rhodiola Rosea, Ashwagandha and various ginsengs have a suite of systemic effects in the body that may help the

individual “adapt” better, under times of stress.

Some are stimulating, some are relaxing.

Some have antioxidant properties, some have anti-inflammatory properties.

My preference for adaptogens is simple, I utilise Rhodiola Rosea as a stimulating, uplifting adaptogen for when extra energy, resilience or focus are needed, while utilising Ashwagandha when a reduction in stress and anxiety is required.

Rhodiola has uplifting effects through dopaminergic neurotransmission, and can be invigorating and energising, while Ashwagandha has some profound sedating and relaxing effects via the GABA pathway, causing relaxation and significant reductions in both cortisol and perceived stress.

I recommend using high quality, organic extracts of these traditional medicine herbs, and using them sparingly (not on multiple days in a row), in doses of 250-500mg on an as needed basis.

They synergise together very well when stimulation and stress reduction are needed simultaneously, such as when doing martial arts, evening exercise sessions, public speaking or creative work.



Note: Both Rhodiola and Ashwagandha have a broad spectrum of effects on the immune system, endocrine system and digestive systems, and they are not suitable for everyone. If you experience over stimulation from Rhodiola or lethargy/anhedonia from Ashwagandha, they are not for you. I recommend Tibetan or Organic Rhodiola and KSM 66/Organic Ashwagandha from companies that use high quality, filler-free capsules such as Paradise Herbs and Dragon Herbs.



MELATONIN, CBD AND GLUTATHIONE

Melatonin, CBD and Glutathione are three powerful antioxidants, that in synergy, help support the body in a chronically inflamed state.

I find in this scenario, CBD can be beneficial in doses as low as 5-10mg, while Glutathione is best taken at a 500mg-1000mg dose in a reduced form, in the morning on an empty stomach, and again before bed, with Melatonin. However, if a subjective effect of CBD is desired, 10-25mg is a light dose, 25-50mg is a moderate dose and 100-200mg is a high dose.

Melatonin should be taken in a micronised form, in as little 100mcg if this is all that is tolerated, up to doses beyond 10mg. Speak to your doctor first about taking more.

I have a discussion with my friend Dr Keith Nichols on high dose melatonin [here](#).

Most will benefit from, and tolerate 1-3mg, with some benefiting from as low as 300mcg and up to 5-10mg, even into the hundreds of milligrams for chronic conditions and advanced disease states.

CBD is mostly taken in the evenings to promote rest and relaxation, but can be taken in the morning too.

Ensure to use a THC free, broad spectrum CBD, or a CBD isolate product if you are taking CBD in the morning, due to driving laws, or if you get drug tested at work.

CBD has clinically been studied in much higher doses for chronic conditions and mental health, and is typically studied in doses of 100mg, 200mg, 300mg, 600mg and even 1000mg and beyond.

I find high doses of CBD are extremely beneficial for sleep and chronic stress conditions, in the dose range of 25mg-100mg. For people wanting to get the maximum effectiveness of CBD before diminishing returns sets in,

I find 100mg 2x daily is the best dose for chronic conditions, and 150-200mg before bed is the upper limit to improve sleep.

CBD is not a cheap supplement, and dosing beyond 50-100mg per day can be cost prohibitive for many people. However, I strongly recommend budgeting for, or at least trialling a 2-3 week period of high doses, if you are having issues with insomnia, chronic stress, pain and auto-immune conditions.



PHOSPHATIDYLSERINE

Phosphatidylserine is the most common supplement I recommend for my clients, due to its consistent tolerability, non-sedating, stress modulating effects that suits both day and night time use.

It is effective not only for improving sleep, but reliably reducing cortisol in blood panels due to psychological stress and anxiety.

As a phospholipid of the conditionally essential amino acid serine, it produces no side effects, and the only downside is that it is less affordable than many other supplements in this book. However, in my experience, it is well worth the price.

Phosphatidylserine is non-sedating, non-habit forming and is beneficial to the brain in contexts of TBI and dementia. It is an anti-stress nutrient that improves sleep quality, evening relaxation and improves sleep architecture, while not causing a groggy “hangover” effect the following day.

It can also be used before nerve-wracking experiences such as public speaking or social situations.

I recommend only using patented forms of Phosphatidylserine such as Serinaid or Sharp, or 100% Phosphatidylserine isolate, as cheaper forms are often only 20-30% phosphatidylserine by weight (you get what you pay for). Brands such as Thorne, Jarrow and Doctors Best make these forms.

Studies have shown that phosphatidylserine only works when consumed with other Omega 3 phospholipids, and is why I recommend combining it with krill oil, fish oil, CBD or taking it with a meal.

I recommend doses of *100mg-600mg* twice daily. For sleep, most of my clients use *200-300mg* before bed. For chronic stress, 2x daily is an effective dosing schedule at *200-300mg*.



Note: *Thorne's phosphatidylserine is 100% isolate, while Sharp and Serinaid are 50% phosphatidylserine by weight, which is why they are more expensive. Doses must be doubled for Sharp/Serinaid accordingly.*



NOOTROPICS

There are many, many nootropics on the market today, that range from mild, amino acid building blocks right up to pharmaceutical amphetamines, and everything in between.

It can be daunting and confronting to go down the nootropics rabbit hole to understand what is safe, what is effective, and what delivers good bang for your buck.

After almost a decade of research, experience and feedback from my clients, at the time of writing this book, these are my recommendations.

Jarrow Neuro Optimiser

Neuro Optimiser has been my go-to nootropic for almost a decade. I have recommended it for hundreds of clients, and it is often overlooked as it lacks the bells and whistles of other nootropic marketing campaigns.

Neuro Optimiser is suitable for just about everyone and everything, due to its lack of stimulation, and the balanced formula gives your brain the building blocks to make everything you want it to make for optimal cognitive function.

I like it for podcasts, writing, public speaking and pre-workout. I find it shines in a double dose too.

You can get Neuro Optimiser everywhere. Amazon, iHerb, or at Whole Foods in the US.

Caffeine + L Theanine

As mentioned in previous chapters, I am a big fan of Caffeine + L Theanine. This is often people's "beginner" nootropic, as it adds a calming, flow-state promoting buffer to caffeine.

I find there to be a strong synergy with TRT, Caffeine and L Theanine.

I prefer to drink my caffeine as high quality coffee, but if you don't like coffee, you can always drink it via another source or get caffeine+theanine capsules. Personally, I like the 200mg L Theanine softgels from Sports Research and pop one if I have a second cup of coffee to sit down and do some deep work.

There are many other great blended nootropic formulas on the market. I recommend trying MRM's "Neuromax II", "Cortex" and "Torque" by Cortex Labs and Quail's "Mind" products.

There are a two of more niche nootropics and cognitive enhancers that I reserve for specific circumstances and contexts:

Modafinil

I have a full, in depth lecture on Modafinil and TRT [here](#).

Modafinil sounds great on paper, it really does. In practice, some will expect it to be comparable to prescription amphetamine or methylphenidate (Ritalin) and will be left disappointed.

Research shows that for Modafinil to be effective on increase dopamine

activity by limiting reuptake, a *200mg* dose is needed, while *50-100mg* doses will work primarily on promoting wakefulness.

If you're doing shift work and need to be awake, alert and productive overnight, or you get off the back of a red-eye flight and have to go straight to a business meeting - this is where Modafinil shines. I recommend *50-100mg*, and making sure to be well hydrated and not take it on consecutive days.

If your goal is to use it to boost productivity, *200mg* is often needed. I recommend combining it with theanine, phosphatidylserine and plenty of protein, to provide the building blocks for dopamine production and to take the edge off, while stabilising blood sugar. It will always hurt sleep no matter how early you take it, so use it sparingly.

For a boost in cognition, creativity and mental energy, I strongly recommend combining one of the nootropic formulas above with a good, strong cup of coffee. A healthy dinner and a good night's sleep the night before shouldn't be underestimated either.

Cerebrolysin

Cerebrolysin is a bioregulator peptide, originating in Eastern Europe and primarily used in Russia and post-soviet countries, along with other bioregulator based peptide medications.

Cerebrolysin is a very strong, injectable medication that contains concentrated brain nutrients and signalling molecules, used in these countries as a treatment for dementia, stroke and other cognitive related conditions.

While cerebrolysin is a powerful nootropic, I prefer to reserve it for when cognition is negatively impacted due to damage to the brain, such as a result of head injury or previous drug abuse. If it is going to be used for cognition in healthy men, I recommend the *2ml* dose only.

*For recovering from brain injury, I recommend 5-10ml per day for 15-20 days, in conjunction with BPC 157 at 200-250mcg 2x daily, as well as other brain nourishing supplements such as high dose Omega 3, magnesium threonate, ubiquinol and PQQ. **Always discuss Cerebrolysin with your doctor before use.***

A large, stylized graphic of red smoke or a cloud, rendered in various shades of red and pink, billowing from the right side of the page and partially obscuring the text box.

**THE LOST CHAPTERS:
MOOD, INFLAMMATION
& CHRONIC PAIN**

Chronic pain is a chronic inflammatory condition that impacts many physiological, neurological and psychological processes in the body.

Many chronic pain sufferers are subjectively experiencing the psychological consequences of this inflammation, such as elevated cortisol, adrenaline, prolactin and estradiol levels, and can often benefit from a supplement protocol that supports the body in this state. For more information on this paradigm, refer back to Your Brain On Testosterone and The War On Masculinity Part 3.

ANTI-INFLAMMATORY STACK:

AM:

- 500-1000mg Reduced Glutathione
- 1-2g Combined EPA DHA from Triglyceride Fish oil
- 10-25mg CBD
- 4 Capsules Thorne Joint Support
- 1 Softgel Thorne Vitamin E

PM:

- 500mg-1000mg Reduced Glutathione
- 1-2g Combined EPA DHA Triglyceride Fish oil
- 1-20mg Micronised Melatonin
- 10-200mg CBD
- 4 Capsules Thorne Joint Support
- 100-300mg Phosphatidylserine

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THE LOST CHAPTERS: CANNABIS

Firstly, this book only covers the legal use of cannabis, whether it is available legally recreationally, or ideally, through medical prescription. All cannabis use needs to be medically supervised. All users of medical cannabis, especially THC, must understand that THC is a psychedelic and is very psychoactive, especially in higher doses. This psychoactivity can be uncomfortable for some people, so if you have no experience, or have had a negative experience with THC, consider forgoing its use without supervision, assistance and discussion around whether it is suitable for you, individually.

Cannabis is a controversial field for multiple reasons.

CBD is often marketed as a panacea, which it is not.

However, it is useful in certain applications, as a calming, health promoting, anxiolytic, that doubles as an antioxidant.

In my experience, it synergises very well with phosphatidylserine, melatonin and glutathione.

CBD can be a useful sleep aid, anti-inflammatory and relaxing agent, that can be included as part of a full spectrum cannabis oil, or isolated as a pure compound. As cannabis has a beneficial “entourage” effect of all constituents including the plethora of other cannabinoids as well as terpenes, I strongly encourage broad or full spectrum products, but be careful around laws for employment testing and driving regulations.

CBD, in my experience shines in doses of 5-10mg for a health promoting effect, and 10-50mg, up to 100mg, for rest, relaxation and sleep.

If THC is going to be used, I strongly advise using it in an oral form, such as edible or oral tincture oil. This is so that the THC can have a slower release into the system and steady metabolism, dosing can be precise, and avoiding unnecessary inflammation to the lungs and carcinogenic byproducts from combustion.

If THC is to be used for sleep, it is best used in doses <5mg, only on seldom occasions, as chronic daily use will dysregulate the body's endocannabinoid system. THC should always be used with CBD for sleep, in at minimum a 1:1 ratio, but ideally with 2-10x more CBD than THC. Keep in mind that THC's psychoactivity can be stimulating and uncomfortable for some, so if you are going to try THC, start with 1-2mg at the most and only increase if no effect is felt.

My favourite brand of CBD at the time of writing this book is Endoca.

**THE LOST CHAPTERS:
ERECTILE DYSFUNCTION**

Erectile dysfunction (ED) is one of the most common issues men bring to me.

Anxiety, as a primary or secondary issue, is almost always a concern.

Erectile dysfunction is a pressing issue amongst young men, particularly those who are unhealthy, but there's a fair amount of psychosomatic (performance anxiety) ED in healthy young men, too.

When men have issues regulating their stress response and are subject to being taken over by anxious thoughts in scenarios they associate with performance (such as intimacy) they develop **a conditioned, hair-trigger flight or fight response.**

This can be made far worse in a scenario when low testosterone is present.

When low testosterone is present, especially in conjunction with chronic inflammation from obesity, drugs and alcohol, the brain's dopamine (reward and GABA calming) systems become dysregulated, and a lack of testosterone to buffer the effects of cortisol and adrenaline makes this situation worse.

When a man lacks a physiological, passionate sex drive to underpin the vulnerabilities which come with intimacy, he becomes much more prone to developing performance anxiety, and creates a physiological environment where his body will drive blood away from his extremities (flight or fight), causing him to inevitably lose his erection.

And while erectile dysfunction medications may help to some degree (especially with confidence of feeling a fuller erection), they do not work as well to offset this stress induced pathway of erectile dysfunction, **as it is less a blood flow issue and more of a stress issue.**

Men can work to improve this area with practising mindfulness meditation and breathing, building confidence in themselves in all aspects and having an honest, loving connection with their partner.

But ultimately, the correct hormonal landscape will need to be laid as a foundation for healthy sexual function to occur.

You cannot have optimal, healthy sexual function in a body which is not physically and mentally healthy.

If you are not on testosterone replacement therapy, or if you are, the recommendations are the same: create an optimally healthy body which would be producing optimal testosterone levels if it could, then work on navigating the mind with confidence and regulation of stress.

Lay the foundations, then build the skill.

Supplements before intimacy such as 300-600mg of Phosphatidylserine, 200-600mg L Theanine and blood flow boosters such as 5-10mg of tadalafil or 6g of L-Citrulline can be helpful, but should not be relied upon as a crutch long term.

For premature ejaculation, look to improve strengthening, stability and mobility through the core, posterior chain and pelvic floor. Ensure strong, healthy hip function and build your stamina in planks and glute bridging. If supplements need to be used, consider 50-200mg of 5HTP prior to intimacy. ***Do not, ever use short acting SSRIs for premature ejaculation.***

I have never met a man who had anxiety induced ED as his ONLY source of anxiety. I see anxiety manifest through sexual function, rather than an isolated incident. Men should focus on addressing their overall anxiety, rather than simply in the bedroom, otherwise it can feel like fighting a losing battle.

Tadalafil is a health promoting erectile dysfunction medication, which not only improves the health of the endothelial lining (cardiovascular system) and prostate, but also improves androgen receptor availability, reduces inflammation and reduces cortisol response to training. Tadalafil can be taken in a 5mg-10mg daily dose, or at 10-20mg on an as needed basis. It has a long half life with an efficacy window of well over 24 hours, and is often recommended alongside TRT for the first 6-12 months, until the sexual benefits of TRT “kick in”.

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**THE LOST CHAPTERS:
ALCOHOLISM, OBESITY
AND CHRONIC STRESS**

ALCOHOLISM

Quitting alcohol is easier said than done.

As discussed in Beyond TRT, fatty liver disease is a key offender in producing side effects on TRT, both when induced by alcohol, or in its non-alcoholic presentation (NAFLD).

While a man is reducing his alcohol intake on TRT, the side effects of alcohol are best mitigated by twice daily supplementation of 1000mg of Reduced Glutathione, as well as 1000mg of Krill Oil as a source of phosphatidylcholine, with the added benefit of additional phospholipids and phospholipid bound EPA DHA.

If a man tests positive for AFLD/NAFLD via a liver ultrasound, a protocol of Choline + Inositol, supported by Glutathione may be indicated for 8-12 weeks depending on the severity.

It is integral to run a post-treatment ultrasound to ensure that fat is cleared, and to repeat the protocol if this is unsuccessful.

This protocol does not work if alcohol is not abstained from for the period, or junk food/pharmaceutical drugs are eaten/used excessively.

2x daily:

- 1000mg Choline Bitartrate
- 1000mg Inositol
- 1000mg Reduced Glutathione
- 1000mg Krill Oil



Note: If the gallbladder is obstructed due to fat on the ultrasound, TUDCA at 500mg or Ox Bile 500mg with major meals containing fat should be added to the protocol above to compensate for the outcomes of poor bile flow.

For those who continue to use alcohol (against the advice of this book) I recommend supplementing with *1000mg-2000mg* of Krill Oil and *500mg-1000mg* of Reduced Glutathione after drinking to mitigate some of the toxic effects of alcohol.

Those who drink alcohol regularly should also consider daily supplementation of *500mg-1000mg* 1-2x per day, or *200mg* intramuscular glutathione injections 1-2 times per week.

You are better off not drinking alcohol AT ALL.

If you are going to drink, I believe 1-2 standard drinks should be reserved only for special occasions (going out for dinner or “Friday night” is NOT a special occasion) such as birthdays, weddings or social conventions where it is appropriate. Being healthy and drinking alcohol regularly is a contradiction. I constantly see men spending hundreds of dollars and dozens of hours a month on health optimisation, to cancel it all out by binge drinking when they feel like it. ***Stop.***

Never drink to intoxication, never drink on consecutive days, never drink alone and never drink to escape reality.

OBESITY

Obesity induced TRT side effects are some of the most prevalent and difficult to manage.

This is because hypogonadism leads to fat gain and other metabolic dysfunction. It is an inevitability that the majority of men beginning TRT, due to hypogonadism, will be overweight to some degree.

While it is helpful to identify this as the root cause, weight loss is not an overnight process.

When an individual has an elevated HBA1C and fasting insulin, and is suffering from TRT side effects, I recommend increasing the frequency of injections to daily, that can be performed into the deltoid with a 29g insulin syringe. Or, consider using compounded cream.

Sick of daily injections? Go to the gym.

Increasing injection frequency is the “turn it off and turn it back on” of TRT. It is the first troubleshooting step, as it’s the easiest and universally solves the most problems. The more body fat you have, the more prone you will be to side effects, and the more you will benefit from injecting.

If an ancillary medication is to be utilised, Metformin at 500mg-1000mg per day is effective in aiding weight loss as well as reducing appetite, reducing elevated blood pressure and correcting insulin resistance induced side effects from testosterone in obese men. Up to 2000mg per day can be used when required.



Pro tip: A mixed source of Vitamin E such as Thorne’s Vitamin E is a great cherry-on-top for improving insulin resistance in addition to Metformin.

To learn more about Metformin, please read my friend Jay Campbell’s phenomenal [Definitive Guide To Metformin](#).

It is also worth considering using a trans-scrotal 20% testosterone cream for men who are obese, as the greater conversion to DHT can have both mood and metabolic boosting benefits, while reducing the side effects of water retention and gynecomastia.

Other key areas to consider when improving insulin sensitivity are intermittent fasting/timing carbohydrate intake around exercise, incorporating multiple 10 minute walks into the day, and avoiding high-fructose corn syrup laden foods and Omega-6 rich vegetable oils.



Note: Losing weight is MUCH easier said than done. Obese men must have comprehensive blood work undertaken and evaluated by a health coach or holistically minded doctor to diagnose and treat any road blocks that may be impeding their weight loss efforts, such as NAFLD, hypogonadism and/or hypogonadism.

If you are having trouble with side effects and weight loss on TRT, consult an informed provider, don't crowd source the "what should I do?" dilemma to Facebook groups or internet forums.

It is also extremely useful to have support from a training and nutrition standpoint. I recommend the following resources:

- Ali Gilbert - Silverback Coaching
- Muscle Nerds
- Jay Campbell - Metabolic Blowtorch Diet
- Mike Dolce - Dolce Diet

CHRONIC STRESS

Chronic stress can occur physiologically or psychologically.

Chronic physiological stress such as physical pain from injuries must be resolved and treated with physiotherapy and corrective exercise.

Far too often, I see men trying to fix mechanical movement issues with peptides and supplements.

However, supplements do have a role in supporting the consequences of physiological stress, while it is in the process of being resolved, especially when TRT is producing side effects.

I have found 1-2 servings of Thorne's Joint Support, 1000mg of Krill oil and 1000-2000mg of EPA DHA from high quality fish oil 2x daily, are effective in modulating the inflammatory by-products of chronic injuries, and also

assist in improving sleep quality for those with chronic injuries. Including CBD at 0.25-0.1mg per kg of body weight can also be synergistic, along with 300-600mg of phosphatidylserine. See “Anti Inflammatory Stack” in the previous chapter.

Chronic psychological stress may be improved with TRT, but TRT alone is often not enough to undo and reprogram years of maladaptive behavioural and psychological programming. In addition to mindfulness and martial arts, I strongly encourage men to seek out a competent therapist or counsellor to guide mental thought processes.

Talk therapy is only as good as the talk therapist, and talk therapy exists to provide you with guidance for solving your problems, rather than solving your problems itself.

For more insights on mental health and therapy, I recommend Pete Isaia's [podcast](#).

Supplements are helpful for chronic stress, but are not cures. Especially when there are biological implications, highlighted by elevations in prolactin, cortisol and reverse T3 together.

I have found the most effective supplement protocol is a combination of 300mg Phosphatidylserine, 200-400mg L Theanine, 3000mg Glycine and 200-500mg of Magnesium Glycinate 2x daily. Including CBD at 0.25mg-0.5mg per kg of body weight, as well as 300-600mg of KSM 66 Ashwagandha can also be therapeutic, however, it is best to stick with nutrient based therapies first due to a reduced chance of side effects.

WRITTEN ARCHIVES

MOVE

Men.

You are the apex predator of Mother Nature, forged by millions of years of evolution of overcoming every adversity since the dawn of human time.

Our bloodlines are the dominant bloodlines.

We are descendants of the winners.

The victors of battle, those who withstood plague and famine, the real survival of the fittest.

Stop being weak.

Your ancestors spent their entire lives surviving from dawn 'til dusk. The potential we have for conquering adversity is infinite and comes from within.

You must overcome your challenges. There are no other options.

Infinite scroll loops and endless distractions of nonsense weaken your focus and deplete your energy. Do not be tamed by authorities who attempt to slave and weaken mankind.

Toxic masculinity does not exist. Masculinity is power, leadership, integrity, honour and controlled aggression. Lack of masculinity allows corruption and evil to thrive unchecked.

Depression is a state of low energy. You must build and grow to express your genetic potential.

You cannot be happy and fulfilled sitting behind a desk under fluorescent light all day. It is impossible. A quarter of the western population are on psychiatric drugs. They are sick. We are growing sicker.

Fight back. Connect with nature. Swim in the ocean. Forge your resilience against heat and cold. Meditate. Fast. Train for endurance, power and mobility.

If you do not have a purpose. Here is a purpose. Prepare for war.

If war comes you will be prepared. If it doesn't, you will be stronger and better for the work you have done. It is a win win.

If you feel low mentally, improve the health of the physical body with relentless, ferocious intensity. You could meditate for an hour every day. You could practice yoga for an hour every day. You could do daily cardio and resistance training. You choose to do these things or not. There are one million excuses not to. But we all have 24 hours in a day. You must make time, as if your life depends on it.

Because your life does depend on it.

MOVE.

SHOW UP

Let me drill in what you learn from doing this all day every day for fucking ages.

It's not genetics that separate people's results on TRT. It's a piece of the puzzle, yeah, everything is.

But the one defining factor that trumps everything else is daily habits.

It's how you show up.

It's ACTUALLY DOING the things you know you're supposed to do.

It's CONSISTENTLY AVOIDING the things you know you shouldn't be doing.

The most common issue is compliance with the basic shit. It really is.

You're. Not. Getting. Away. With. It.

Are you ACTUALLY hitting 10k steps a day?

Are you ACTUALLY training with the intensity you like to think you are?

Are you ACTUALLY trying as hard as everyone else who has the results that you don't?

THAT'S the issue.

You're not missing the magic supplement or the magic biohacking routine or the magic macro tweak or whatever you're googling while you're NOT DOING THE THING THAT'S UNCOMFORTABLE.

Anxious? Why aren't you meditating daily. It's free. You could do it right now if you actually wanted to.

Fat? Why aren't you hitting 10k steps? It's hot? Good, sweat. Free sauna. It's raining? Cool. You're waterproof. Free shower.

No muscle? Who's your trainer? You don't have one? How do you expect to do something that you haven't been properly taught how to do?

Show me someone who has insomnia and I'll show you someone with shit sleep hygiene.

Show me someone with depression and I'll show you someone living a depressing life.

Show me someone who's anxious and afraid and I'll show you someone who lacks the competence to be confident. You're probably not the 1 in 1000 who's genetically doomed in your deficits.

You're probably the 999 in 1000 who doesn't have the right strategy or isn't applying themselves properly. You can fix your shit. You can. It's probably just harder than you thought it would be.

I'M ANXIOUS ABOUT...

Are you?

Is something making you anxious, or are you an anxious person and you're simply fixating your anxiety on a moving target?

Has the thing you used to say would make you anxious resolved?

I see people who point the finger at what makes them anxious, rather than recognising that they are constantly finding something to be anxious about, and when that thing resolves or gets replaced by a bigger problem, they move on to that.

It's normal to be anxious about things in life. In fact, it would be strange if you went through life without anxiety. Many things are objectively anxiety inducing. It's about the ability to overcome anxiety, or to put it aside and make room for it, but not to succumb or be debilitated by it.

Anxiety is not an excuse for anything externally. No one respects someone who uses anxiety as reason for not doing what they need to do. No one. So, it should not be an internal excuse either.

You are not supposed to be fearless, you are supposed to overcome your fears.

Bravery and courage don't remove anxiety, they push through it.

If you find you are anxious about anything and everything, you have likely been neglecting one or more aspects of your development.

Are you pushing your comfort zone regularly? Are you living up to your potential? Are you competent in a skill or service that creates meaning or provides value? Are you honest with yourself and others?

Perhaps the anxiety is a smoke alarm going off, and it's a signal that you're not getting away with not doing what you know you should be doing, or doing what shouldn't be doing.

Perhaps you're experiencing the outcome of being behind the 8 ball and finding out where that ends up. Or perhaps you're pathologising life being harder than you thought it would be.

ORIGIN STORY

Let this year be your origin story.

If you're feeling like crap and you're off the path, what else do you really have to do anyway?

I constantly hear people say, don't make too many changes at once, you won't stick to it. It's not sustainable.

Maybe YOU won't stick to it.

You know what else isn't sustainable? Terrible diet, lifestyle and relationships with drugs and alcohol. Imagine if in 2, 5 or 10 years you're recounting the last 12 months as when you pushed outside your comfort zone, applied extraordinary effort to achieve extraordinary results.

The extraordinary results that many people feel entitled to, despite not doing the work they know needs to be done.

There's an ugly, uncomfortable mirror that goes up when you call yourself out on not being who you could be. But that reflection is a reflection that will get uglier and uglier with the days, months and years of complacency that fly by.

Getting up earlier and forcing compliance to a constructive, disciplined daily routine is hard. But it's not THAT hard.

In fact, when you build yourself into the person you could be and level yourself up, the rest of life becomes easier because you're more equipped to handle the curve balls that are inevitably coming your way.

You've been given the gift of life and a capable body to achieve more. And you only get one body and one go at this.

You have multiple innings left to play.

Start prehab now.

Train every day.

That way when you step up to the plate, you can take a big swing and maybe you'll even knock it out of the park.

DRUGS, ALCOHOL, JUNK FOOD + NOT DOING ENOUGH EXERCISE

Drugs (including SSRIs and hairloss "medications"), alcohol and junk food are the "big 3" when it comes to chronic disease that I see in practice.

Layer this with not doing enough exercise, and you have the gamut of preventable chronic disease that plagues the majority of the population. These catalysts are the primary drivers for the major diseases of aging: cancer, heart disease, diabetes and dementia.

If you knew how you were going to die, how would you live differently, now?

I have been saying for some time now, the most important thing you can do is stop doing the things you know you shouldn't be doing and start doing the things you know you should be doing.

And to fit the expectations of how you want to look, feel and be, you needed to make those changes consistently 6-12 months ago.

Will these lifestyle changes solve all your problems? Maybe. Maybe not.

Will these lifestyle changes help all your problems? Yes. Absolutely.

I think one of the secondary benefits of removing escapism through these means of intoxication, hedonism and artificial, degenerative and unhealthy dopamine spikes is it lifts the curtain on the reality of where you are truly at, and forces you to make change to break discomfort.

And if you stick to these rules and principles, it forces you to make changes that might not be as acutely relieving of the discomfort (such as intoxication) but ultimately will gradually move you away from a reality that you seek to escape or numb in the first place. Audit. Your. Shit.

Not thriving?

You're not getting away with whatever you're trying to get away from.

You can't out train a bad diet? You can't out bio-hack a bad lifestyle.

And you can't out-medicate a broken body either. Be who you could be.

TRY

Just a friendly reminder,

You are an adult, the peak of human evolution, mother nature's apex predator and the dominant bloodline of history.

You can train on an empty stomach.

You can function on a poor night's sleep.

You can do the hard thing.

The untapped potential in your DNA, coursing through your veins is endless. You have so much capacity to overcome whatever life will throw your way.

Stop selling yourself short.

Stop tapping out before you even fight.

Try.

CONCENTRATION AND WILLPOWER

These are the two fundamental mental skills you must develop and become adept in to get to where you want to go. The cross section is where the magic happens.

The bullshit narrative which you must abandon is that these are inherent traits. These are learned skills, and you can cultivate mental strength with your mind the same way you can cultivate physical strength with your body in the gym.

WILLPOWER

You must have a purpose and be able to apply yourself to said purpose. You have to have a reason why you want to do the things you say you want to do. And the immediate discomfort, delay of gratification or sacrifice must be lesser than the long term gratification, satisfaction and accomplishment this will achieve. This is a trade that you must make to get what you want, and it is a mental battle you must learn to overcome.

I have met many people who subscribed to the philosophical belief that there is no such thing as free will. They were all victims of circumstance and completely fucking miserable, avoidant and often addicted to disassociation in various forms.

You do have free will. But you need a purpose, a mission, or a passion to be able to exert it, to get done the things you need to get done in order to get what you want.

CONCENTRATION

The mental skill of attention comes more naturally to some than others. Some people are able to focus with laser precision on things that interest them, but have virtually no ability to focus on things that don't.

This is a disorder of behaviour, not a neurological condition. Find any research paper which conclusively proves the contrary, I dare you. It doesn't exist.

Your mental focus is a skill that has to be honed like any other. Your ability to focus on a task that you don't want to do, or do the "means to the end" is vital to achieve any success in anything that isn't hedonistic or serves a greater purpose. Life is full of work that needs doing that you don't want to do.

Modern distractions, technology, terrible diet and conditioning of immediate gratification make this skill difficult, but not impossible. It makes it rare, which makes it even more valuable. And if you want exceptional results, then you need to do what is extraordinary to earn this.

THE CROSS SECTION

I meet many men each week, and have met thousands in the last few years. I see some overcome insurmountable odds to achieve what they thought was impossible. And I've seen others flounder in a pathetic, self-destructive cycle of learned hopelessness and failure.

What's interesting, and reflects the wisdom passed down by Paul Chek, is that someone's objective physical ailment or their disease state is often the lesser determining factor in their recovery. The primary determining factor is if they have a REAL REASON to put the work in to heal themselves.

It is the purpose, drive, inspiration and passion that fuels each tiny, day to day decision and adds up to get you back on track and moving towards your goal. And it is the focus and discipline that facilitates this purpose and passion being applied, when the temptations arise or the path of least resistance rears its ugly head day in, day out.

Have a reason, and learn HOW to do what you NEED to do. Set a goal, break it down into smaller goals and put one foot in front of the other until it's done. It's not rocket science. But it's not easy either.

YOU'RE THE COMMON DENOMINATOR

Here's a tough pill to swallow.

You can change your circumstances all you like. You can change your surroundings all you like.

Are some surroundings and circumstances more misery inducing than others? Absolutely.

But remember, you are the common denominator in the series of events you know as your life.

And if misery follows you, and you're always looking to change your surroundings to find the greener grass on the other side, you might find that your perception of the external has more to do with the radiation of what's shining from within.

Competence breeds confidence. The people around you will bring you up or pull you down with them.

Cultivate your worth, master yourself and skills, and show up day in day out with consistent effort and positive practices. Even when, and especially when, no one else is watching.

Then watch as your perception of the world around you shifts in turn.

ALCOHOL

Alcohol is one of the worst drugs in the world due to its toxicity threshold required to reach intoxication.

Alcohol has been ingrained into our culture via media, advertising and social conventions. It serves a role in many cultural traditions, and has done so for a really, really long time.

Alcohol is a euphoric, dissociative depressant. A euphoric depressant may sound paradoxical, but most drugs of intoxication illicit varying degrees of euphoria due to their actions on dopamine, and this euphoria is short lived compared to its depressive effects. However, the euphoric, dopaminergic “hit” is enough to result in habit forming patterns of behaviour, especially when there are social cues, such as certain venues, events, or in the cases of vicious cycles and self destructive behaviours, emotional triggers.

I personally prefer not to drink alcohol whatsoever. I don't like the taste, and as someone who is clued into their cognitive function quite closely (I am on camera all day, every day), I am very aware that it negatively affects my cognitive performance for at least a week, if I drink in a social setting.

I am also very aware of its impact on the gut, and this is something that is not discussed enough. Alcohol is extremely harmful to all aspects of the gut. The mucosa, microbiome and digestion while drinking is all negatively impacted. If you are taking ANY form of gut support supplement and drinking alcohol regularly, you are punching yourself in the face and taking painkillers. You just might not realise why you keep

getting hit in the face.

One of the most harmful conventions we have around alcohol is drinking at the end of a hard day, or when processing bad news. This is reinforced in fiction, particularly in movies and television, as well as the archetype of a beer or whiskey alone at a bar. Adding a toxic depressant to a challenging situation in life is a poor strategy. When you re-associate with reality the next morning, with a toxic liver and an irritated gut, you're going to feel worse – and the “benefit” at the time doesn't outweigh the consequence. There's a reason why waking up with a hangover and saying “I'm never drinking again” is such a cliché.

I've said it here recently – regular “social drinking” or any kind of drinking to intoxication is one of the key, preventable things guys do to fuck up their health. You don't get away with it and it catches up with you like getting hit by a freight train. It's not a problem until it is. Alcohol consumption is so strongly associated with poor physical and mental health outcomes in my practice – more than anything else I have seen thus far.

Cutting down alcohol consumption significantly to no more than 1-2 drinks per week (ideally zero) and most importantly, eliminating binge drinking (4-5 standard drinks) entirely, is one of the most impactful things you can do to improve your health. Whether you like it or not, it is.

I DON'T WANT TO, SO I WILL

"I don't want to, so I will. I don't want to, so I will. I don't want to, so I will".

I don't think anyone wakes up with a hard on for doing a bunch of work they don't want to do. I certainly don't.

I think the quest into self -development also comes from an ugly point of discomfort, which is a new low or pain that finally forces not just one change, but a repeated series of changes. Sometimes this change is not towards a clear goal, but the goal can simply to be to get away from where you are now.

That might get glamourised in your montage story when you look back on the dark, long roads you've overcome to get to where you are. But there's a hell of a lot of blindly putting one foot in front of the other to find your way out of the darkness. And there's a shit tonne of fear, panic and anxiety sprinkled on top.

You will not want to do the work you don't want to do. You're not supposed to. Otherwise you, and everyone else you know, would be exactly where you want to be, by default. You're not. We're not.

Your circumstances may suck but your circumstances can also change should you choose to change them.

I don't want to, so I will.

DOING IT ALL

Two of the most valuable processes to practise on a regular basis are doing things you're learning, a student of, and are a novice at, as well as doing things that you've mastered, leading others in, and are adept at.

Life feels better when you do things you're good at, regularly. This works at a neurotransmitter level, as well as a flow state of consciousness, where things come "naturally" and you are in rhythm effortlessly, and creating something of which you can be proud.

However, if we simply play our strengths all the time, our comfort zone will encroach inwards, and the skills that we've mastered may be narrow in scope, or lack diverse utility to be able to conquer and navigate the challenges of life.

It is equally important to balance these areas of mastery with learning new skills, being humbled by starting at square 1, and being the worst person in the room, which may be across the hallway from the room where you're the best.

This not only keeps your ego in check (important) but expands your skillsets, resilience and discipline, while allowing you to prepare mentally and physically for the inevitable curve balls life will throw, if it hasn't already.

Remember that being a jack-of-all-trades and master-of-none leads to frustration and less utility than you'd hope. What are you good at? What skills do you possess naturally, or as a result of decades of practice that others don't? Play those strengths. But don't forget to fortify your weaknesses and step out of your comfort zone regularly, because these skills will translate not only into your strengths, but also into the unknown.

It's never this or that. It's always both. You have to do it all. But measure your self-worth and give yourself credit what credit is due for what you're exceptional at. Just don't compromise on adaptability while you're at it.

STOP UNDERESTIMATING YOURSELF

One thing that grinds my gears as a coach is hearing you under estimate yourselves.

The biggest driving motivators in my life have been when people have told me I can't do something.

If you have goals, or a dream, and YOUR OWN voice is the voice telling you that you can't do it before you even try, then this is a one way, fast track ticket to a life riddled with anxiety and depression.

It is far better to take an unrelenting, epic swing at what you want to achieve and come up short, or fall flat on your face, than never even try in the first place.

This pattern of behaviour edges in on your comfort zone. It will close in smaller and smaller until your internal monologues track record of feeble, half ass attempts, procrastination and avoidance start to become the defining characteristics of your identity.

The people who were once your friends begin to move forwards with their lives and outshine you. They cast a shadow on your insecurities and lack of resilience and your social circle becomes surrounded by others who encroach a nihilistic, bitter and jealous attitude that takes hold of your psyche.

Your social circle should hold you accountable. They should expect the best from you. They should celebrate your wins as you should celebrate theirs. You must surround yourself with people who push you forward and not hold you back. And in turn, you must show up in that way and magnetise people who have earned your respect and you theirs.

And there is nothing more respectable than those who fall flat on their face, get back up, and take another swing at it.

Hope for the best and plan for the worst. Unless the worst is certain death or serious danger, there's more to lose by not trying. You might learn something. You might realise that you're only using 10% of your potential. As Andrew Tate says, when in doubt, make the brave choice.

BUILD A FEEL-GOOD MACHINE

Being alive feels better when your body is physically healthier.

If you don't take care of yourself, you make less dopamine in response to things that you SHOULD enjoy because chronic inflammation suppresses dopamine production, synthesis and increases reuptake.

You can break your feel good machine.

When you go to the gym and move your body it feels more stressful and less pleasurable when your cardiovascular fitness is poor and your blood pressure is high because the engine is too small to run the car.

If you can't push your body to exert decent power and endurance outputs you will never achieve a healthy natural level of endorphins and endocannabinoids that make you feel good.

You need to be able to get high on your own supply, and you need to live a life which incorporates this function on a regular basis.

The guy who has what you want and enjoys moving around, living his life and the sensations of being ALIVE – he DESERVES it because he is a product of consistent self-care, delayed gratification and doing the right thing, long term.

You cannot trash your body and expect to have optimal physical or mental health. This entitlement is what leads to disempowerment and living a life that becomes depressing.

You can't expect to have the results of the work you're not willing to do.

It needs to feel good to play on the playground of life. You need to be a healthy functional human being to live a life that is enjoyable, to live without hedonism and self destructive vices, or drugs to modify your neurochemistry to make you feel like you are doing better than you are.

Build the capacity to perform. Fuel well. Move SIGNIFICANTLY more. Practise mobility DAILY. Work smarter AND harder. Rest hard too.

Whatever it is that comes to mind when you read this - you're not getting away with it.

Do 10 burpees. Have a big stretch outside. Walk around your neighbourhood. How do you feel?

TAKE BETTER CARE OF YOURSELF

Why don't you take care of yourself half as well as you would take care of someone you love?

The people you love are just as flawed as you are, you just see them through a different, rose tinted lens than the harsh 20/20 vision you use to judge yourself.

And you should judge yourself harshly. You should hold yourself accountable and set high standards for yourself to ultimately allow you to live the best life you can live by becoming the best version of yourself.

You know how you show up when no one is watching. But you cannot thrive without nurturing when you are down and out. Especially if you are at rock bottom. And it has to start with self love.

And to be worthy of self love you have to be someone who you're proud to be.

This doesn't mean your circumstances have to be perfect. Life is much more about how you perform and react under adversity. This is what shapes you into who you are and in what direction you are headed.

Start by doing the small things. Be a good person. Have good values. Keep promises to yourself. Do the right thing. Do not buy into the societal conditioning that you should hate yourself – this is a psyop to make you buy their products to fill the void inside you that they put there in the first place.

Self- deprecating, depressed and ashamed people are easy to control. Passionate, powerful people who have something to live and die for are dangerous.

Don't hate being you. The journey of your success will be that much more impressive the further off track you are right now. Look after yourself every day so you can wake up every day and show the hand that life dealt you and that you WILL NOT KNEEL.

Find strength where others find defeat.

ADULTHOOD

I think there's multiple pivotal points in life where you realise that what you want is harder to get than you thought.

I think those points are harder to overcome with each passing year because instant gratification rewards are getting easier to get as technology evolves.

I think if you're not driven by an overarching purpose like family, God or a rigid set of core values and beliefs that create a truly meaningful purpose, you're highly likely to be knocked off your path, if you haven't been already.

We need to want it more, and we need the "why" to want it enough to stick; to continue to show up and do the right thing, day after day for a long time.

I think the "why" creates the DRIVE that overcomes lapses in motivation and conquers less ideal circumstances.

I think a lot of anxiety and depression is the outcome of what happens when you don't have a "why" to keep you on track.

YOU HAVE TO BUILD THE HOUSE BEFORE YOU LET ANY GUESTS IN

Run a marathon without mastering your mobility? Good luck with your hips and ankles.

CrossFit before you learn to master your body weight? Good luck with your back.

Taking care of your kids before you learn to take care of yourself? Good luck with your marriage.

Entering a relationship before you've become someone worthy of self love? Good luck with projecting your insecurities.

Starting a business before you know how a business works? Good luck with your debt.

Start the self mastery, self improvement and positive daily habits NOW so that you don't fuck up whatever opportunity is coming your way.

POTENTIAL

Whether you believe we were made in the divine image of God.

Or forged through millions of years of evolution.

You were built to endure and overcome the harshest adversity of nature. Resource scarcity, extreme environments and predators. It's in your DNA and those who came before you were the strongest who survived.

You were not born broken and incapable. If cleaning your room and staying on top of your basic day-to-day responsibilities are a struggle you cannot handle, it's not because you are broken, it's because you need help.

You need help to build capability, capacity and resilience to handle the REAL challenges of human existence. It is then and there that the neurosis heals and you can unlock the true capability of the apex predator of planet earth.

Life is supposed to be hard. But you're supposed to be harder. Just like every ancestor in your blood line who came and went before you.
We all have the potential.

YOU

Judge yourself by the actions you take, and the person you are behind closed doors when no one is watching. That's "you".

Not the social facade. Not the instagram photos.

Who are you really? Are you proud of who you REALLY are?

ANOTHER POST ABOUT ANXIETY

Understand that anxiety is a normal part of the human experience.

We all experience anxiety to varying degrees, but the degree to which we “suffer” from it varies. I do not believe people are ever truly fearless, they just overcome their fears.

Anxiety is a tricky beast for a number of reasons. The biggest issue I see is paralysis by analysis, and people identifying with their anxiety as an ailment rather than a challenge to overcome.

There is a vicious cycle at play. You get anxious about something and avoid it. You continue to avoid it, and other things that make you anxious, and eventually you fall behind. The gap between where you should be and where you are grows, you feel guilty and helpless, which makes you more anxious, and you end up leading a depressive life as a result. Then you’re anxious and depressed.

I also see people constantly reacting to their anxiety. The fight or flight state overrides impulse control, logic and reasoning, and poor, short sighted decisions are made in a panic. This is a poor attempt to “self soothe” and often ends up being one step forward in the short term and two steps back in the long term.

Supplements and pills calm the anxiety signal but they do not “fix” the “problem” by any means.

You are supposed to have some degree of fear of the unknown. It’s a survival mechanism.

You are supposed to feel anxious about things with a risk, especially if those risks have the potential for things like humiliation or “failure”, which are damaging to the ego.

You are supposed to get anxious about doing things you don't know how to do, especially if there are high stakes.

You are supposed to be uncomfortable with situations that make you vulnerable.

This is part of the human existence. There is nothing more insidious than getting anxious about getting anxious. You must learn to overcome it.

I encourage you to do a few things. Firstly, focus only on what you can control. Hope for the best, and plan for the worst. And finally, learn to become aware of your stress response and gain some degree of control over it. This is the skill of mindfulness which can be cultivated, practised and re-enforced through meditation.

You must push your comfort zone, regularly. You must follow through on the things you tell yourself you will do. You must set goals and you must try your damndest to achieve them, even if you come up short. We harden up by cultivating resilience through overcoming challenges and we soften up just the same by being avoidant.

Next time you are anxious about something, think about the worst thing that could happen. Unless it's death or a fatal injury, try just doing it anyway and hope for the best. You'll be surprised what you are capable of when you stop succumbing to fear.

And when you start to recognise your own capacity, get some achievements under your belt and start to progress away from the person you don't want to be towards the person you can be. That's when you become unstoppable.

Try. Just try.

COURAGE

Pull yourself together and face the world with the courage of the person you could become.

I see a lot of guys who are looking for the secret hack, method or motivation to allow them to put their plan into action.

Not all of us, but a lot of us, know what we need to do to get where we need to go.

If not that, we know that if we started doing x, y and z and stop doing a, b and c CONSISTENTLY that we would be far better off for it.

So, what's stopping you?

For some of you, it's self limiting beliefs. A learned fear from a variety of things. Lack of encouragement during development, no history of discipline and goal setting/achieving, repeated failed endeavours or no positive male role model to be accountable to, aspire to emulate and be supported by.

For others, it's not enough self accountability. It's too much "letting it slide", seeing if you can "get away with it" or just not hitting a low enough point to be at "rock bottom", so the short-term hedonistic vices are just too appealing.

And lastly, for others, it's entitlement. It's a belief that you can legitimately get to where you want to go and have all the things you want without the hard work, sacrifice and discipline, not understanding the real world volume of effort needed to get there. And when

there's the resulting gap between expectations and reality, you become jaded.

Or it's all three combined.

These are not you. These are your stories. And you can let them go and choose to rewrite the story and be the man you want to be. You can, yourself, be the catalyst you are looking for to make change, and that change is a choice.

Some men don't believe in free will. I do believe that these men have no free will. But for those who have courage and have the capacity to build the strength from within, you can exert the free will to make a drastic, radical change in your life from this moment forward, drop your bullshit and be the person who you never thought you could be.

You just need to do it.

Imagine where you could be in 6 months, or 6 years, or as little as 6 weeks if you make these changes, right now. You know what needs to be done. Don't look for the inspiration, the motivational speech or the "5 best ways", just do it. Start now.

WE ARE ALL JUST WALKING EACH OTHER HOME

This is one of my favourite Ram Das quotes I shared on Instagram and in some mentoring sessions that struck a chord with some people.

I think it's easy to get stuck in a hedonism and pleasure cycle. It's easy to be thinking about "me me me", but in practice, this can lead to chronic feelings of suffering and emptiness that can often, surprisingly, be resolved by being of service to others.

However, be conscious of who you give your time, love and energy to; save it for those who you trust and who respect you.

A lot of people have ascribed different meanings to this quote, and at the end of the day, quotes like this are tools for me to anchor myself in the present moment, and be aware of how my actions impact those around me, and what is really important.

Rather than getting caught up in squabbles with your loved ones, reacting emotionally or being "up in your head" and missing the simple moments like a dinner with your family or alone time with your spouse, remember this.

We are all on the same journey. We are all born and we will all die. Make sure the ones you love know you love them, as you never know when their journey might end. You're not perfect so don't expect them to be. Let the little things go.

Be good company for the ones with whom you walk the path of life. This is a purpose.

We are all just walking each other home.

10 FACTS

Here's 10 fun facts I learnt this year through observation and my discussions with you guys, at scale:

1. Diet and lifestyle is more important than supplements and ancillary medications. I'd trade a \$1000 a month supplement stack for 6 eggs a day, plenty of red meat and organic fruit, potatoes and dairy. Supplements don't have as much of an ROI as they are marketed to have unless they are for a specific purpose.

2. Casual alcoholism is a much bigger problem than people realise. If you're not thriving and drinking more than 2-3 standard drinks per week, stop the booze, you're likely not getting away with it. Just because your mates can do it, doesn't mean you can.

3. Guys are way too blasé around AAS use on TRT. If you've started TRT in the last 12 months and you're deconditioned or lack muscle mass, you have zero business taking steroids. Up your protein, take some creatine, go to the gym more and be patient to fix the mess you made. Don't be surprised if your doctor doesn't renew your prescription if you don't take your medication as prescribed. I have become a big fan of the every 4 months blood test for this reason – it's crazy to complain how hard TRT is to get and then to ignore your provider's advice and abuse your medication. If you want to do a "cycle" hit some high dose EAAs/extra WPI with creatine, carnitine, choline and Vitamin D, and train HARD and MORE. You are so far from "over training" that I wouldn't even think twice about it.

4. Life is hard in a lot of ways, and getting hit with the realities of the world doesn't mean you have a mental health condition or need psychiatric drugs. You need new skills, a network of like-minded individuals and a mentor or role model, and a big glass of toughen the fuck up. Willpower, discipline and focus are things that have to be learnt and not having them by default doesn't make you a failure, it means you have work to do. And that's okay, because we all have to start from somewhere.

5. Heaps of you aren't eating enough protein.

6. IIFYM causes more problems than it solves if you don't stick to the 80/20 rule.

7. Prescription NDT works way better than T3+T4 if the ratios suit your needs. This previously wasn't available, but now is, so if you're having thyroid issues on T3+T4 look into this.

8. Paying an extra \$15 per vial for MCT is worth the money. If not, at least get grapeseed for the faster injections.

9. Changing the carrier oil to MCT/Grapeseed/Sesame from Cottonseed/Caster allows the vast majority to tolerate SubQ that can be a welcome change after years of IM, but, "if it ain't broke, don't try to fix it".

10. TRT takes years to work, not weeks and months.

WHERE YOU ARE NOW IS NOT WHERE YOU WILL ALWAYS BE

Many men start testosterone replacement therapy, or at least begin delving into the topic of TRT, when they consciously or subconsciously observe:

“High testosterone men don’t have the problems that I have.”

This is true.

While hypogonadism does not cause a man to make the wrong decisions or possess him in a way where he loses accountability to himself and others, it predisposes him towards different physiological and psychological responses to both stressors and opportunities.

Over time, multiple steps in the wrong direction instead of multiple steps in the right direction result in a man becoming far removed from the man he could, and should be.

The high testosterone man does not have the same problems, not because of his serum concentrations of testosterone in that moment, but in the months and years of putting in the work, building habits and forming an identity around a more androgenic inner monologue. Starting TRT is day 1 and this shit takes years and the journey lasts a lifetime.

Where you are now is not where you will always be.

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AFH

www.advancedfundamentalhealth.com

"To put it simply Dave changed my life. I had a myriad of autoimmune diseases really lowering/limiting my quality of life/motivation/personality. His expertise and wealth of knowledge helped me get treatment that wasn't just the cookie cutter western medical version, but fine-tuned to my individual needs and deficiencies.

It can be overwhelming trying to take control of your health especially when suffering from chronic fatigue and depression as a result of your conditions, while also trying to wade through the plethora of misinformation to find something that will actually make a difference.

I had been let down many times by doctors taking the easy route, I wanted more than just enough to get by and function subpar.

I didn't even know I could feel the way I do now, and I'm still not even at 100% yet! It does take time to heal, but will be so worth it, and I have Dave to thank for his perseverance and answering my unending questions. I'm for the first time feeling in control of what felt like a constant battle with my own body. He has an intrinsic motivation to help and get to the bottom of what's causing these health issues, not just mask the symptoms.

Thank you, Dave!"

— Hannah S

"Advanced Fundamental Health shed a light on men's health, assisting those in need, who have been failed by the medical system. Dave's approach for holistic health picks up the slack left by medical practitioners who only know how to apply blanket treatments.

Dave addresses diet, lifestyle and medicine, referring clients to other professionals who are adept in their fields. Thank you Dave, Advanced Fundamental Health and associates for all your efforts."

— William D



YOUR BRAIN ON TESTOSTERONE,
THE WAR ON MASCULINITY
& THE LOST CHAPTERS

"I was lucky enough to come across Dave at Advanced Fundamental Health late in 2021.

In 2017 I lost a testicle to testicular cancer. Unfortunately, my testosterone levels were not checked prior to surgery but not long after surgery I was feeling different, and not in a good way. Tired, irritable, low energy and not much motivation. I saw a urologist and although my levels were at the low end, he would not prescribe medication as I was in "the range". I have no doubt my levels had dropped as my factory was now working with one on the production line instead of two.

Dave had me do a full panel and my levels were low but in the range. My issue was that as my testosterone was not checked before surgery, we had no way of knowing what it was previously. I held off starting TRT until late 2022.

It took me a good six months to feel good again and some eight months later I'm feeling the best I have in 30 years. I am currently 55 years old. Possibly a little tweaking to do after my next lot of bloods and session with Dave but I have no issue in recommending Dave for anything TRT related.

Thank you, Dave."

— Jim V

"For anyone who wants to take their overall well-being, mental and physical health to the next level, Advanced Fundamental Health are amazing to work with and deliver optimal results.

Dave Lee takes a personal and holistic approach, looks at your symptoms, lifestyle and blood work and then provides a well thought out approach to symptom resolution.

With Advanced Fundamental Health, you get access to on-going support and information in regards to TRT and men's health through the eyes of a passionate and integrous practitioner that genuinely cares about the individual and the evolution of the space we are in."

— Jonathan L

